

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

Phase 13: Testing & Deployment Validation

Purpose: Validate the complete incident lifecycle automation and confirm that incident handling, escalation, change integration, knowledge creation, child incidents, SLA tracking, and multi-team collaboration work correctly before final deployment.

Testing and Validation Steps

- Verify the incident record is created with the correct caller, description, category, priority, assignment group, and configuration item.
- Confirm the incident progresses through the expected lifecycle states without missing or incorrect transitions.
- Validate reassignment and escalation to the appropriate Level 2 support team.
- Verify SLA information is visible and continues to track correctly throughout the incident lifecycle.
- Confirm the emergency change request is created and linked correctly when a change is required for resolution.
- Verify the configuration item is updated when the required infrastructure change is completed.
- Create a child incident from the parent incident and confirm the parent-child relationship is displayed in Related Records.
- Resolve the incident and verify the resolution code, resolution notes, and resolved state are recorded correctly.
- Confirm knowledge creation is completed from the resolved incident and the created article is visible in Related Records.
- Verify that activity history provides a clear audit trail of assignments, escalations, changes, child incidents, and resolution activities.

End-to-End Test Scenario

Test Area	Expected Result
Incident Creation	Incident is created with complete and accurate details.
Classification	Category, subcategory, priority, and CI are correctly populated.
Assignment & Escalation	Incident reaches the correct support team and Level 2 when required.
SLA Tracking	Applicable SLA is attached and tracking is visible.
Change Integration	Emergency change is created, linked, and used for the required fix.
Child Incident	Child incident is created and linked to the parent incident.
Resolution	Incident and child incident reach the expected resolved state.
Knowledge	Useful resolution information is converted into a knowledge article.
Final Validation	All records, links, activities, and states are consistent.

Deployment Readiness Checklist

- All configured workflows and business rules execute successfully.
- No critical validation errors are observed during testing.
- Incident, change, child incident, knowledge, and SLA records are correctly linked.
- User roles and access permissions allow the required teams to perform their activities.
- The activity/audit history provides sufficient traceability for support and review.
- The end-to-end scenario is repeatable and produces the expected results.
- The solution is ready for final review and deployment validation.

Phase 13 Outcome

Phase 13 confirms that the Incident Lifecycle Automation solution functions correctly from incident creation through escalation, change integration, child-incident handling, resolution, knowledge creation, and final validation. Successful testing demonstrates that the implementation is ready to proceed to the conclusion phase.